MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS ENGLISH

CORE REVISION GUIDE • FULL COMPREHENSION MANUAL

LEVEL 1




# READING SKILLS

A step-by-step guide to full marks in Level 1 reading comprehension

Comprehension Skills | Text Types & Layout | Specialist Vocab | Mock Papers

ENGLISH READING LEVEL 1

# Functional Skills English • Reading

Level 1 • Complete Study & Comprehension Mastery Manual

| This book belongs to: | Exam date: | Target level: |
| --- | --- | --- |
| _____ | _____ | _____ |

## What is inside


| | | |
| --- | --- | --- |
| 1–12 | All 12 Core Reading Topics & Comprehension Drills (48 pages) | p. 5 |
| EXAM | Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Reading Strategy & Question Types (6 pages) | p. 53 |
| M1–M2 | 2 Complete Official Pearson Reading Mock Exam Papers (16 pages) | p. 59 |
| RUB | Official Pearson Edexcel Reading Mark Schemes & Assessment Grids (6 pages) | p. 75 |
| REF | Complete Step-by-Step Solutions, Reading Glossary & Index | p. 81 |
| REV | Candidate Pre-Exam Readiness Commitments & Progress Matrix | p. 85 |


## How to use this book

**Read**
Read the rule. Study the picture.

**Try**
Write your answers on the lines.

**Check**
Mark it with the answers at the back.

**Remember**
Learn the Golden Rule by heart.

CURRICULUM ARCHITECTURE • DFE SUBJECT CONTENT L1.9 TO L1.17

SPEC

# Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Reading • Specification Overview

## Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Reading Assessment Format

**Examination Structure:** The Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills English Level 1 Reading paper is an externally assessed, **60-minute** examination worth **30 marks**.

Candidates must read and comprehend **two to three non-fiction texts** drawn from real-world contexts (such as workplace safety notices, community leaflets, operational emails, news articles, and web pages).

- **Question Types:** Multiple-choice questions, straightforward retrieval, explaining vocabulary in context, identifying organizational features, and distinguishing fact from opinion.
- **Timing Strategy:** Aim for approximately **2 minutes per mark**. Spend 10–12 minutes reading the source texts carefully before tackling the questions.
- **No Dictionaries:** Dictionaries and spellcheckers are not permitted during the examination.

## Golden Reading Rule

Always re-read the specific paragraph referenced in the question before selecting your answer.

## Examiner Warning

Never rely on personal background knowledge — every answer must be evidenced directly from the text.

## ✎ Personal Target Score & Reading Strategy Priorities

AUDIT

BASELINE SKILLS AUDIT

# Level 1 Candidate Diagnostic Matrix

## Core Functional Skills Level 1 Reading Competencies

Evaluate your confidence across the core Level 1 Reading standards before starting:

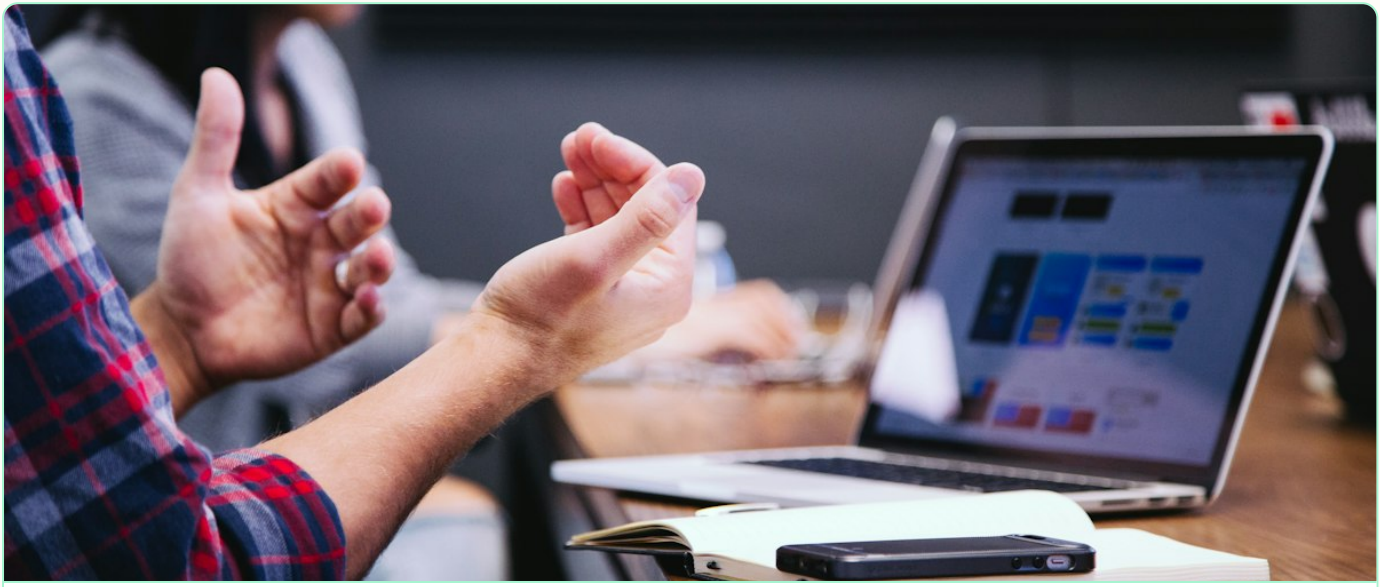
- Can you quickly separate objective facts from personal opinions in a workplace article?
- Can you work out the meaning of unfamiliar words by reading the surrounding sentences?
- Can you identify why a writer has used bullet points, subheadings, or bold text?
- Can you find specific information in an email, memo, or website in under 60 seconds?
- Can you explain the main purpose of a text (to inform, instruct, explain, or persuade)?

## ✎ Reading Skills I Need to Practise Most

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R1

# Reading Topic 1: Fact or Opinion



Study context for Fact or Opinion.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

• **L1.9 / L2.9:** Identify and distinguish between fact and opinion in workplace and informative texts.

• **L2.14:** Recognise bias and determine whether statements represent verifiable truth or subjective interpretation.

**Key Concept:** A fact is verifiable using data, records, dates, measurements, or official statistics. If a statement can be checked against records and proven true or false, it is a fact — even if you personally disagree with it.

## Golden Rule

Opinions reflect feelings, beliefs, interpretations, or recommendations. Look out for evaluative adjectives ('superb', 'appalling', 'vital') and modal verbs ('should', 'must', 'ought to').

## Examiner Trap

Just because a senior doctor or consultant says 'This is the best ward management app available', that does not make it a fact. It remains an informed professional opinion.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • NHS HEALTHCARE COMPLIANCE

# Fact or Opinion • Text Analysis

## Source Text • NHS Healthcare Compliance

**Extract • Hospital Ward Inspection Report Analysis:**

Read the extract from the hospital audit report:
*'Ward 4 admitted 142 patients in October. The nursing staff provided exceptional, heartwarming care throughout the winter surge. Patient discharge waiting times exceeded 3 hours.'*
(a) Identify one fact.
(b) Identify one opinion.
(c) Explain why the opinion cannot be verified as an objective fact.

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Identify the verifiable factual statement):** Option A: 'Ward 4 admitted 142 patients in October' OR Option B: 'Patient discharge waiting times exceeded 3 hours.' Both can be verified from hospital admission logs. **[1 Mark (A1 Fact)]**
2. **Step 2 (Identify the subjective opinion):** 'The nursing staff provided exceptional, heartwarming care throughout the winter surge.' **[1 Mark (A1 Opinion)]**
3. **Step 3 (Explain why the opinion is unverifiable):** 'Exceptional' and 'heartwarming' are evaluative value judgments based on subjective personal feelings rather than clinical numerical metrics. **[1 Mark (A1 Justification)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

MODEL

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

# Fact or Opinion • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

Fact: 'Ward 4 admitted 142 patients in October' | Opinion: 'The nursing staff provided exceptional, heartwarming care' | Reason: It uses evaluative adjectives reflecting personal perception.

## Examiner Guidance

In Pearson Edexcel exams, always copy the exact quotation for the fact and opinion, and make sure your explanation clearly mentions subjective language or lack of measurable proof.

## Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

## ✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

DRILL

EXAM PRACTICE • 2 MARKS

# Fact or Opinion • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 2 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

A logistics fleet report states: *'The electric delivery vans cut depot fuel expenditure by £14,500. They are undeniably the most stylish commercial vehicles on British roads today.'*
Extract one fact and one opinion from this statement.

**✎ Write your response below (2 Marks):**

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R2

# Reading Topic 2: Words in Context & Meaning



Study context for Words in Context & Meaning.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

• **L1.10 / L2.10:** Identify meanings of words and phrases and determine how meaning is conveyed.

• **L2.11:** Understand and explain implicit and explicit meanings across extended texts.

**Key Concept:** Never define a word in isolation. Look at the sentences before and after the target word to see how it operates within the passage's vocational situation.

## Golden Rule

Literal words express their exact dictionary definition. Figurative words create comparisons that must be translated into plain English.

## Examiner Trap

A word like 'critical' can mean 'finding fault' or 'of crucial clinical importance'. Always select the definition that fits the vocational scenario.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • SOCIAL CARE QUALITY ASSURANCE

# Words in Context & Meaning • Text Analysis

## Source Text • Social Care Quality Assurance

**Extract • Care Home Policy Handbook Vocabulary:**

An extract from the residential home guidelines states:
*'Staff must remain vigilant regarding subtle fluctuations in a resident's baseline vital signs.'*
(a) In this context, what is the meaning of the word 'vigilant'?
(b) What is meant by 'fluctuations'?

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Define 'vigilant' using the clinical supervision context):** 'Vigilant' means being alert, watchful, observant, or carefully attentive to changes. **[1 Mark (A1 Meaning)]**
2. **Step 2 (Define 'fluctuations' in relation to vital signs):** 'Fluctuations' means variations, shifts, irregular rises and falls, or changes in measurements over time. **[1 Mark (A1 Meaning)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

MODEL

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

# Words in Context & Meaning • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

(a) Vigilant: Alert, watchful, or attentively monitoring. (b) Fluctuations: Irregular changes, rises and falls, or variations.

### Examiner Guidance

Avoid using the target word itself in your explanation. Always use a clear synonym or descriptive phrase.

### Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

### What Makes This Answer Successful

DRILL

EXAM PRACTICE • 2 MARKS

# Words in Context & Meaning • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 2 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

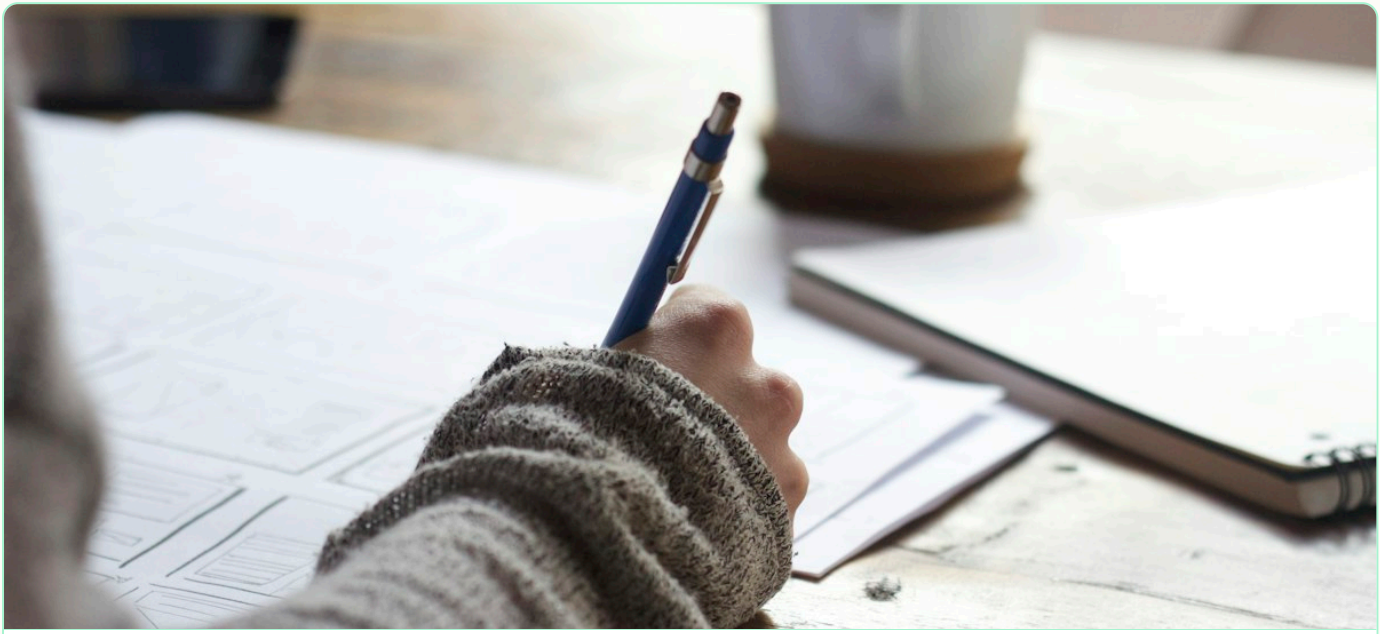
A safety notice reads: *'Failure to isolate electrical equipment prior to maintenance poses imminent danger.'*
Explain what is meant by 'isolate' and 'imminent' in this context.

**✎ Write your response below (2 Marks):**

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R3

# Reading Topic 3: Specialist & Technical Vocabulary



Study context for Specialist & Technical Vocabulary.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

• **L1.11 / L2.11:** Understand and explain specialist and technical vocabulary in vocational texts.

• **L2.12:** Recognise jargon and understand when glossaries, brackets, or context define technical terms.

**Key Concept:** Authors of informational texts frequently define technical acronyms or jargon immediately upon first mention using parentheses (e.g. PPE – Personal Protective Equipment) or a glossary box.

## Golden Rule

Many specialist words combine standard roots, prefixes, and suffixes (e.g., 'bio-degradable', 'hyper-tension'). Use familiar word roots to deduce meaning.

## Examiner Trap

Exam questions often test whether you know that 'RIDDOR', 'COSHH', or 'MAR' refer to specific official regulations or medical records.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH & SAFETY

# Specialist & Technical Vocabulary • Text Analysis

## Source Text • Occupational Health & Safety

**Extract • Warehouse Safety Induction Protocol:**

A warehouse safety manual states:
*'Operatives must adhere to ergonomic guidelines when handling palletized freight to mitigate musculoskeletal strain.'*
(a) What is meant by 'ergonomic guidelines'?
(b) What does 'mitigate' mean in this sentence?

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Define ergonomic guidelines):** Practices or posture rules designed to fit the human body safely and minimize physical strain during lifting. **[1 Mark (A1 Definition)]**
2. **Step 2 (Define mitigate):** To reduce, lessen, alleviate, or make less severe. **[1 Mark (A1 Definition)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

# Specialist & Technical Vocabulary • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1/2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

(a) Rules designed for body safety and correct lifting posture. (b) To reduce, lessen, or prevent the severity of strain.

### Examiner Guidance

Keep definitions clear and simple. Explain technical jargon as if speaking to a newly hired colleague.

### Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

### ✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM PRACTICE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

# Specialist & Technical Vocabulary • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 2 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

A pharmacy dispensing notice states: *'The oral suspension is contraindicated for patients with renal impairment.'*
Explain what is meant by (a) 'contraindicated' and (b) 'renal impairment'.

**✎ Write your response below (2 Marks):**

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R4

# Reading Topic 4: Presentational Features



**Photo**

photo coming soon

Study context for Presentational Features.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

• **L1.12 / L2.12:** Recognise and explain how presentational features aid understanding and convey information.

• **L2.13:** Analyse how formatting, organizational signposts, and visual features support authorial intent.

**Key Concept:** You never receive marks simply for naming a feature (e.g. 'bullet points'). You must explain WHAT that feature achieves for the reader in that specific text.

## Golden Rule

A main heading states the overarching topic or hooks interest; subheadings break down complex multi-step processes into scannable chunks.

## Examiner Trap

Alliteration, rhetorical questions, and metaphors are language techniques. Bold fonts, tables, bullet points, and headers are presentational features.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • FACILITY MANAGEMENT & SAFETY

# Presentational Features • Text Analysis

## Source Text • Facility Management & Safety

**Extract • Fire Evacuation Workplace Notice Analysis:**

Examine a workplace emergency evacuation poster.
(a) Identify two different presentational features used in the poster.
(b) Explain how one of these features helps staff during an emergency.

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Identify two distinct presentational features):** Feature 1: Bold red subheadings ('PRIMARY ASSEMBLY POINT')
   Feature 2: Numbered bullet points for step-by-step escape actions. **[2 Marks (A1 Features)]**
2. **Step 2 (Explain the practical effect on the reader in an emergency):** The numbered bullet points present the evacuation sequence step-by-step so that panicked employees can follow instructions rapidly in order without having to read dense blocks of text. **[1 Mark (A1 Effect)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

MODEL

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

# Presentational Features • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

(a) Bold red subheadings AND numbered bullet points. (b) The numbered list allows staff to follow sequential escape steps rapidly during high-stress situations.

### Examiner Guidance

Never give vague answers like 'it makes it look pretty'. Always explain how it functionally assists reader comprehension.

### Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

### ✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

DRILL

EXAM PRACTICE • 2 MARKS

# Presentational Features • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 2 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

An NHS appointment booking portal features a prominent yellow shaded box at the top stating: *'Urgent: Please arrive 15 minutes before your scheduled scan.'* Identify the presentational feature and explain its purpose.

**✎ Write your response below (2 Marks):**

R5

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

# Reading Topic 5: Layout Devices & Visual Signposting




Study context for Layout Devices & Visual Signposting.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

• **L1.12 / L2.12:** Understand how layout and structural devices organize complex information.

• **L2.13:** Analyse the relationship between textual hierarchy, columns, margins, and reader navigation.

**Key Concept:** Layout is structured so the most important message occupies top-left prominence (banner headline), followed by secondary details in columns, and administrative notes in footers.

## Golden Rule

Ample line-spacing, margins, and cell padding isolate critical data blocks, making reading accessible for adults with dyslexia and cognitive processing differences.

## Examiner Trap

If asked about layout, do not summarize the words! Discuss columns, spacing, callout boxes, and alignment.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • PUBLIC HEALTH COMMUNICATIONS

# Layout Devices & Visual Signposting • Text Analysis

## Source Text • Public Health Communications

**Extract • Community Clinic Health Leaflet Layout:**

A vaccination guide uses a three-fold leaflet format with a separate colored sidebar titled 'Walk-in Clinic Times'.
(a) Why did the designer place clinic opening times in a dedicated sidebar?
(b) How does this layout benefit a working parent needing a booster jab?

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Explain the architectural purpose of the sidebar):** The sidebar physically separates practical logistics (times, venues) from the dense clinical information in the main body. **[1 Mark (A1 Purpose)]**
2. **Step 2 (Explain the direct benefit to the target audience):** A busy parent can immediately locate operational times without having to scan through paragraphs explaining vaccine science. **[2 Marks (A1 Benefit)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

# Layout Devices & Visual Signposting • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

(a) Isolates practical appointment logistics from background clinical explanations.
(b) Enables busy readers to find dates and times instantly without reading the entire document.

### Examiner Guidance

Focus on the practical vocational convenience delivered by the layout.

### Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

### ✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM PRACTICE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

# Layout Devices & Visual Signposting • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 2 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

A staff intranet page presents payroll submission deadlines in a centered two-column table rather than continuous prose. Explain two advantages of this table layout.

**✎ Write your response below (2 Marks):**

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R6

# Reading Topic 6: Images, Graphics & Captions



**Photo**

photo coming soon

Study context for Images, Graphics & Captions.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

• **L1.13 / L2.13:** Analyse how images and graphical representations support or extend written content.

• **L2.14:** Evaluate the rhetorical and persuasive impact of visual imagery in campaigning and informational texts.

**Key Concept:** Images are never decorative in exam papers. They serve an explicit rhetorical function: evoking empathy, illustrating safety hazards, or demonstrating clinical anatomy.

## Golden Rule

The caption provides the intended interpretation of the image. Always read the caption to verify dates, identities, statistical context, or clinical significance.

## Examiner Trap

Saying 'The picture shows a nurse' scores 0. You must explain why the nurse was chosen: to represent frontline dedication, professionalism, or clinical expertise.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • CHARITABLE HEALTHCARE FUNDRAISING

# Images, Graphics & Captions • Text Analysis

## Source Text • Charitable Healthcare Fundraising

**Extract • Air Ambulance Charity Campaign Analysis:**

Text A includes an image of a paramedic kneeling beside an emergency trauma pack, smiling alongside a young patient recovering from surgery.
(a) What emotion does this image evoke in potential donors?
(b) How does this image support the text's headline: 'Every Second Counts, Every Pound Saves Lives'?

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Identify the emotional response evoked):** Evokes hope, relief, warmth, gratitude, and empathy. **[1 Mark (A1 Emotion)]**
2. **Step 2 (Link image content directly to the headline message):** The smiling, healthy patient provides tangible visual proof of the life-saving impact of donor funding, demonstrating that immediate paramedic intervention leads directly to positive recovery. **[2 Marks (A1 Rhetorical Link)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

# Images, Graphics & Captions • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

(a) Evokes empathy, relief, and hope. (b) Provides tangible photographic proof that donor funding translates directly into saved human lives.

### Examiner Guidance

Always link the visual depiction (paramedic with recovered patient) directly to the specific words in the headline.

### Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

### What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM PRACTICE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

# Images, Graphics & Captions • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 2 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

A recycling campaign poster includes a photograph of sea turtles swimming amongst single-use plastic bottles. Explain why the author selected this specific image rather than just stating waste statistics.

**✎ Write your response below (2 Marks):**

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R7

# Reading Topic 7: Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques



**Photo**

photo coming soon

Study context for Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

• **L1.14 / L2.14:** Identify language techniques and explain how they influence the reader.

• **L2.15:** Analyse rhetorical devices used to persuade, inform, critique, or advocate in workplace communications.

**Key Concept:** To score full marks on language questions in Pearson Edexcel, follow the 3-step formula: 1. Technique Name -> 2. Direct Quote -> 3. Impact on reader thoughts/feelings.

## Golden Rule

The 'Rule of Three' creates rhythm, finality, and psychological memorability. Emotive words trigger emotional resonance rather than neutral logic.

## Examiner Trap

Writing 'it catches the reader's eye and makes them read on' is the #1 reason candidates fail language questions.

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • NHS CLINICAL RECRUITMENT

PASSAGE

# Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques • Text Analysis

## Source Text • NHS Clinical Recruitment

**Extract • Healthcare Recruitment Drive Article Analysis:**

Read the extract:
*'Are you ready to make an indelible mark on patients' lives? Nursing offers a career of purpose, passion, and pride. Do not let this once-in-a-lifetime calling slip through your fingers.'*
(a) Identify one rhetorical question.
(b) Identify one example of the rule of three.
(c) Explain the effect of the phrase 'slip through your fingers'.

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Quote the rhetorical question exactly):** 'Are you ready to make an indelible mark on patients' lives?' **[1 Mark (A1 Quote)]**
2. **Step 2 (Quote the rule of three triplet):** 'purpose, passion, and pride' **[1 Mark (A1 Quote)]**
3. **Step 3 (Explain the metaphorical effect):** The metaphor 'slip through your fingers' creates a sense of loss and urgency, warning candidates that failing to apply will result in missing a precious opportunity. **[1 Mark (A1 Effect)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

# Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

(a) 'Are you ready to make an indelible mark on patients' lives?' (b) 'purpose, passion, and pride' (c) Metaphor creating urgency and fear of missing a valuable career opportunity.

### Examiner Guidance

Copy quotations word-for-word inside quotation marks. When explaining impact, use action verbs like 'compels', 'dramatizes', 'creates urgency'.

### Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

### ✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM PRACTICE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

# Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 2 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

A union safety flyer states: *'Tired nurses make dangerous mistakes. Safe staffing is a matter of life and death.'* Identify one language technique used in 'life and death' and explain its intended effect.

**✎ Write your response below (2 Marks):**

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R8

# Reading Topic 8: Point of View, Bias & Argumentation



**Photo**

photo coming soon

Study context for Point of View, Bias & Argumentation.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

- **L2.14:** Recognise bias and determine whether arguments are balanced or one-sided.
- **L2.16:** Trace lines of argument and evaluate whether conclusions are supported by rigorous evidence.

**Key Concept:** A balanced, objective text presents both advantages and disadvantages, citing opposing perspectives before responding with evidence. A biased text omits counter-evidence entirely.

## Golden Rule

Bias frequently stems from vested financial, political, or institutional interests. If a software provider praises their own app, recognize inherent commercial bias.

## Examiner Trap

Just because an author writes with deep emotion and compelling adjectives, that does not mean their argument is factually proven.

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • DIGITAL HEALTHCARE PROCUREMENT

PASSAGE

# Point of View, Bias & Argumentation • Text Analysis

## Source Text • Digital Healthcare Procurement

**Extract • Private Telehealth App Editorial Analysis:**

Read the editorial written by the CEO of 'InstantDoctor Ltd':
*'Traditional GP surgeries are relics of the past. Our revolutionary app guarantees consultations in 3 minutes, solving Britain's healthcare crisis overnight.'*
(a) Identify the author's point of view.
(b) Give two pieces of evidence showing this text is biased.

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (State the author's point of view clearly):** The author believes digital app consultations are superior to traditional GP clinics and represent the total future of healthcare. **[1 Mark (A1 Viewpoint)]**
2. **Step 2 (Identify evidence of bias):** Evidence 1: Loaded, dismissive language describing GP practices as 'relics of the past'.
   Evidence 2: Unsubstantiated hyperbole ('solving Britain's healthcare crisis overnight') written by a CEO who profits directly from app subscriptions. **[2 Marks (A1 Evidence)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

# Point of View, Bias & Argumentation • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

(a) Point of view: Digital telehealth apps are superior and should replace standard GP surgeries. (b) Bias evidence: 1. Insulting GP surgeries as 'relics'. 2. Vested commercial interest as company CEO making exaggerated claims without independent trial data.

## Examiner Guidance

In Level 2 papers, identifying the author's vested interest (e.g. CEO promoting their own commercial software) demonstrates high-level critical reading.

## Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

## What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM PRACTICE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

# Point of View, Bias & Argumentation • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 2 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

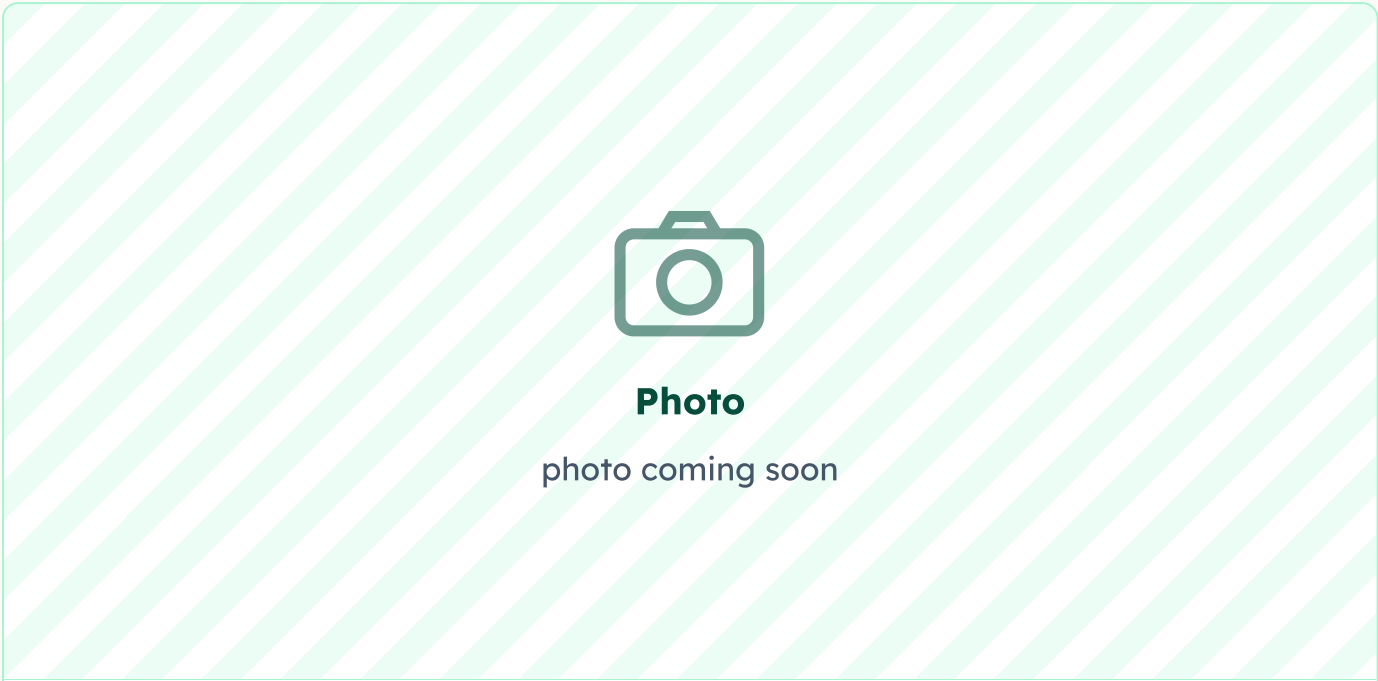
A trade union newsletter argues: *'The proposed roster overhaul is an unmitigated disaster designed solely to exploit staff.'* Identify the author's stance and explain why the phrasing demonstrates bias.

**✎ Write your response below (2 Marks):**

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R9

# Reading Topic 9: Tone, Style & Writer's Voice




Study context for Tone, Style & Writer's Voice.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

- **L1.15 / L2.15:** Identify the tone and style of texts and explain how register communicates attitude.
- **L2.16:** Evaluate how authorial voice establishes credibility, empathy, or professional detachment.

**Key Concept:** Tone is not just what is said, but HOW it is expressed: humorous, clinical, encouraging, outraged, cautionary, or authoritative.

## Golden Rule

Formal register uses passive voice, polysyllabic vocabulary, and objective detachment. Informal register uses colloquialisms, contractions, and direct address.

## Examiner Trap

A text about a tragic topic might be written in a detached, factual, clinical tone rather than an emotional one.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • HEALTHCARE PATIENT RELATIONS

# Tone, Style & Writer's Voice • Text Analysis

## Source Text • Healthcare Patient Relations

**Extract • Hospital Complaint Response Letter Tone Analysis:**

Read the opening paragraph:
*'We have thoroughly investigated your grievance regarding your mother's care on Ward 2. We sincerely regret the unacceptable distress caused by the communication delay, and we have instituted immediate corrective safeguards.'*
(a) Describe the tone.
(b) Quote two words or phrases that establish this tone.
(c) Explain why this tone is appropriate.

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Describe the tone accurately):** The tone is apologetic, professional, empathetic, and constructive. **[1 Mark (A1 Tone)]**
2. **Step 2 (Quote supporting vocabulary):** Quote 1: 'sincerely regret'
   Quote 2: 'unacceptable distress'. **[1 Mark (A1 Quotes)]**
3. **Step 3 (Explain contextual appropriateness):** Validates the family's legitimate grief while reassuring them with formal accountability and systemic remedial action. **[1 Mark (A1 Appropriateness)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

MODEL

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

# Tone, Style & Writer's Voice • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

(a) Apologetic, empathetic, and professional. (b) 'sincerely regret' and 'unacceptable distress'. (c) Acknowledges serious distress while reassuring the complainant that corrective action has been taken.

### Examiner Guidance

Avoid generic words like 'good' or 'nice'. Use precise descriptors like 'apologetic' or 'authoritative'.

### Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

### ✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

DRILL

EXAM PRACTICE • 2 MARKS

# Tone, Style & Writer's Voice • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 2 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

A dental hygiene flyer asks: *'Hate flossing? We get it, it feels like a chore! But your gums will thank you.'* Describe the tone and quote one colloquial phrase.

**✎ Write your response below (2 Marks):**

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R10

# Reading Topic 10: Text Types, Purpose & Audience



**Photo**

photo coming soon

Study context for Text Types, Purpose & Audience.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

- **L1.16 / L2.16:** Identify different text types, purposes, and audiences across informational and transactional materials.
- **L2.17:** Recognise structural conventions distinguishing persuasive articles, operational reports, and transactional letters.

**Key Concept:** Articles persuade or entertain; Reports inform and evaluate; Manuals instruct; Letters initiate transactional requests.

## Golden Rule

Salutations & sign-offs indicate letters; Subject lines and CC fields indicate emails; Headings, subheadings & columns indicate articles or reports.

## Examiner Trap

An explanatory text tells the reader HOW something works objectively. A persuasive text aims to CHANGE the reader's opinion or compel an action.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • HEALTH AND SOCIAL CARE REGULATORY REPORTING

# Text Types, Purpose & Audience • Text Analysis

## Source Text • Health and Social Care Regulatory Reporting

**Extract • Care Quality Commission Inspection Summary Evaluation:**

You are presented with a document headed: *'CQC Provider Audit: Cedar Grove Residential Home - Ref 884-B'* featuring numbered subheadings, compliance rating tables, and statutory recommendations.
(a) Identify the text type.
(b) State the primary purpose.
(c) Identify the target audience.

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Identify text type from conventions):** Formal audit report / Inspection evaluation document. **[1 Mark (A1 Text Type)]**
2. **Step 2 (Determine the primary purpose):** To evaluate, assess, and report on compliance standards and order necessary regulatory improvements. **[1 Mark (A1 Purpose)]**
3. **Step 3 (Identify target audience):** Care home management, local authority social care commissioners, and prospective residents' families. **[1 Mark (A1 Audience)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

# Text Types, Purpose & Audience • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

(a) Formal audit / inspection report. (b) To evaluate regulatory compliance and state remedial recommendations. (c) Care home managers, local council commissioners, and residents' families.

### Examiner Guidance

Audience answers should be specific. Rather than writing 'people', state 'care home management and healthcare commissioners'.

### Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

### ✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM PRACTICE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

# Text Types, Purpose & Audience • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 2 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

A document titled: *'Staff Guidance Note: Safe Disposal of Sharps and Clinical Waste'* contains numbered imperative steps and safety symbols. Identify the text type and its primary purpose.

**✎ Write your response below (2 Marks):**

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

R11

# Reading Topic 11: Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives



**Photo**

photo coming soon

Study context for Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

- **L2.17:** Compare and contrast information, ideas, and perspectives across two extended texts on the same subject.
- **L2.18:** Synthesize evidence from multiple sources and identify points of agreement and disagreement.

**Key Concept:** Never write about Text A in one isolated paragraph and Text B in another. Weave them together using comparative discourse markers: 'Similarly', 'Whereas', 'In sharp contrast', 'On the other hand'.

## Golden Rule

High-scoring comparative answers contrast not only factual content, but the author's underlying attitudes, emotional tone, and persuasive techniques.

## Examiner Trap

Summarizing Text A on page 1 and Text B on page 2 scores 0 for comparison. You must compare them in the exact same sentences.

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • EMERGENCY SERVICES FLEET MODERNIZATION

PASSAGE

# Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives • Text Analysis

## Source Text • Emergency Services Fleet Modernization

**Extract • Electric Ambulances Fleet Transition (Text A vs Text B):**

Text A is a government press release promoting green emergency fleets.
Text B is an interview with an active paramedic union representative.
Compare how the two texts convey differing perspectives on replacing diesel ambulances with electric vehicles.

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Contrast authorial stance and optimism):** Text A takes an optimistic stance, claiming electric ambulances will 'slash urban emissions by 40% and save millions in fuel', whereas Text B presents a skeptical perspective focusing on operational risks. **[1 Mark (A1 Stance Contrast)]**
2. **Step 2 (Contrast perspectives on vehicle reliability and charging):** Text A emphasizes technological advancement ('rapid charging in 20 minutes'), while Text B emphasizes frontline reality ('charging stations are nonexistent in rural areas, leaving crews vulnerable during emergency surges'). **[2 Marks (A1 Synthesis with Quotes)]**
3. **Step 3 (Integrate comparative connective and conclusion):** While both texts agree emissions must fall, Text A prioritizes environmental targets, whereas Text B prioritizes patient response times and emergency safety. **[1 Mark (A1 Comparative Synthesis)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

# Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 4 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

Text A presents an enthusiastic environmental perspective, arguing green fleets will 'slash emissions by 40%', whereas Text B adopts a cautious, safety-first stance, warning that rural areas lack charging infrastructure and could endanger patients during surges.

### Examiner Guidance

Notice the use of 'whereas' and direct quotations from both texts. This structure guarantees maximum marks.

### Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

### ✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM PRACTICE • 3 MARKS

DRILL

# Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 3 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

Text A states: *'Remote video appointments empower patients by eliminating travel.'*
Text B states: *'Virtual appointments alienate elderly patients who lack digital skills.'*
Compare the viewpoints using a comparative connective.

**✎ Write your response below (3 Marks):**

R12

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 1 READING

# Reading Topic 12: Authorial Intent & Target Audience




Study context for Authorial Intent & Target Audience.

## DfE Criteria & Core Concept

**Curriculum Standard:**

• **L1.17 / L2.17:** Identify authorial purpose and determine why texts were produced.

• **L2.18:** Analyse how purpose dictates lexical choice, structural hierarchy, and reader call-to-actions.

**Key Concept:** Professional authors choose every statistic, quote, and formatting device to drive their core motivation: securing donations, changing health habits, winning a contract, or ensuring compliance.

## Golden Rule

Authors speaking to teenagers adopt relatable vernacular; authors speaking to clinical directors use formal medical precision and compliance standards.

## Examiner Trap

A text may contain facts and statistics, but if it ends with 'Donate Now' or 'Sign the Petition', its primary purpose is persuasive advocacy.

PASSAGE

AUTHENTIC WORKPLACE CONTEXT • TRANSFUSION SERVICE PUBLIC CAMPAIGN

# Authorial Intent & Target Audience • Text Analysis

## Source Text • Transfusion Service Public Campaign

**Extract • NHS Blood Donation Appeal Motivation Analysis:**

An NHS campaign text features an emotive story of a child surviving leukaemia thanks to platelet donors, ending with: *'Give blood today. 60 minutes of your time is someone's lifetime.'*
(a) Why did the writer include the child's recovery story?
(b) What is the main purpose of the closing call to action?

## Tutor Step-by-Step Analysis Strategy

1. **Step 1 (Analyse the emotional motivation for the story):** The author included the child's story to forge an emotional bond with the reader, humanizing the abstract concept of blood shortages and proving that donations save young lives. **[2 Marks (A1 Motivation)]**
2. **Step 2 (Analyse the closing call to action):** The closing statement serves to compel immediate, tangible donor registrations by contrasting the minimal personal sacrifice (60 minutes) with the immense life-saving outcome. **[1 Mark (A1 Call to Action)]**

## ✎ Key Clues & Vocabulary Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS EXEMPLAR

MODEL

# Authorial Intent & Target Audience • Benchmark Model Answer

## Full Marks Benchmark • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1/2)

**Model Candidate Answer:**

(a) To evoke deep empathy and prove the real-life medical impact of donating. (b) To compel immediate registration by making the sacrifice feel tiny compared to saving a child's life.

### Examiner Guidance

Identify both the emotional mechanism (empathy) and the behavioral objective (booking a donor slot).

### Mark Scheme Criterion

Examiners award marks for exact quotes or accurate paraphrasing that directly answers what was asked.

### ✎ What Makes This Answer Successful

EXAM PRACTICE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

# Authorial Intent & Target Audience • Candidate Practice

## Independent Practice Task • 2 Marks

**Comprehension Task:**

A hospice director publishes an article titled: *'Dignity at the End: Why Palliative Care Deserves Equal Funding.'* State the author's primary motivation for writing this article.

**✎ Write your response below (2 Marks):**

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

EX1

# Exam Masterclass 1: Managing Your Time: The 1-Minute-Per-Mark Rule

### Core Examination Technique

In a 60-minute exam for 30 marks, you have exactly 2 minutes per mark. Allocate your time systematically: 10 mins reading texts, 40 mins answering questions, 10 mins checking.

### Top Scoring Strategy

Read questions first so you read with a purpose.

### Common Exam Pitfall

Never get stuck on a 1-mark question for more than 2 minutes.

### ✎ My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 1)

EX2

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

# Exam Masterclass 2: Retrieval Questions & Locating Facts

### Core Examination Technique

Retrieval questions ask you to find a specific piece of information (who, what, where, when, how much). Scan for capital letters, numbers, and key verbs.

### Top Scoring Strategy

Keep answers short and factual.

### Common Exam Pitfall

Don't copy entire paragraphs when only one phrase is needed.

### ✎ My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 2)

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

EX3

# Exam Masterclass 3: Working Out the Meaning of Unfamiliar Words

### Core Examination Technique

When encountering specialist or difficult words, read the sentence before and the sentence after. The surrounding context almost always provides a synonym or explanation.

### Top Scoring Strategy

Check if a glossary, bracket, or footnote explains the word.

### Common Exam Pitfall

Substitute a simpler word to test if the sentence still makes sense.

### ✎ My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 3)

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

EX4

# Exam Masterclass 4: Understanding Organizational & Layout Features

### Core Examination Technique

Writers use headings to introduce topics, subheadings to organize sub-topics, bullet points to list items concisely, and bold text for visual emphasis.

### Top Scoring Strategy

Always explain HOW the feature helps the reader (e.g. 'makes it easy to scan').

### Common Exam Pitfall

Do not just say 'it looks nice' or 'it grabs attention'.

### ✎ My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 4)

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

EX5

# Exam Masterclass 5: Distinguishing Fact, Opinion & Bias

### Core Examination Technique

A fact can be proved true with evidence, statistics, or records. An opinion expresses personal belief, feelings, or value judgments ('best', 'terrible', 'undoubtedly').

### Top Scoring Strategy

Facts can be proven; opinions reflect feelings.

### Common Exam Pitfall

Watch out for opinions hidden inside quotes from employees or experts.

### ✎ My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 5)

PEARSON EDEXCEL READING STRATEGY

EX6

# Exam Masterclass 6: Final Checking & Proofreading Strategy

### Core Examination Technique

Use your final 10 minutes to verify every answer. Ensure you haven't left any multiple-choice boxes blank and that your written answers are clear and legible.

### Top Scoring Strategy

Even a guessed multiple-choice answer gives you a 25% chance of a mark.

### Common Exam Pitfall

Check that you have copied dates, names, and phone numbers accurately.

### ✎ My Exam Strategy Notes & Personal Rules (Masterclass 6)

MOCK 1

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 1 • 60 MINUTES • 30 MARKS

# Official Reading Mock Examination • Paper 1

## Examination Protocol

**Instructions for Candidates:**

- This paper contains 3 reading texts (Text A, Text B, and Text C).
- Answer all questions in the candidate spaces provided.
- Total time allowed: 60 minutes. Total marks: 30 marks.
- You may not use a dictionary or spellchecker.

## Pacing Rule

Spend 10 minutes reading all texts thoroughly before beginning the questions.

## Mark Allocation

Check the marks allocated to each question. A 2-mark question requires 2 distinct points.

## ✎ Personal Target Score & Time Checkpoints

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

M1

# Mock 1 • Text A: Greendale Community Health & Wellbeing Centre

## Reading Passage

The Greendale Health & Wellbeing Centre opens Monday to Friday from 08:00 to 19:30. We provide free confidential health checks, NHS smoking cessation clinics, and diabetes prevention workshops. To book an appointment, telephone 01865 774200 or visit our reception desk in Zone 2. Patients attending morning clinics may use the visitor car park free of charge for up to two hours.

1 **Question 1:** According to Text A, what time does the Wellbeing Centre close on weekdays? (1 mark)

2 **Question 2:** Identify two free health services offered by the centre. (2 marks)

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

# Mock 1 • Text A Continued & Questions

## Reading Passage

Please note that evening workshops require advance booking at least 48 hours in advance. If you cannot attend your scheduled appointment, you must notify staff so another patient can be offered your time slot. Missed appointments cost the centre over £12,000 each year.

1 **Question 3:** How much notice is required to book an evening workshop? (1 mark)

2 **Question 4:** Explain one consequence mentioned in the text if a patient misses an appointment. (1 mark)

3 **Question 5:** What is the main purpose of Text A? (1 mark)

- ☐ To complain about NHS funding
- ☐ To inform the public about services and opening hours
- ☐ To advertise private gym memberships
- ☐ To instruct readers how to become a doctor

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

# Mock 1 • Text B: Customer Feedback & Public Reviews

## Reading Passage

Review by David T. (5 Stars • Verified Visitor):
*'I visited the Greendale Wellbeing Centre yesterday for a blood pressure check. The nurse, Sister Sarah, was exceptionally kind and reassuring. The modern waiting area was spotlessly clean and spacious. The automated check-in screen was effortless to use. Without a doubt, this is the finest healthcare facility in Oxfordshire!'*

1 **Question 6:** Extract one fact from David's review. (1 mark)

2 **Question 7:** Extract one opinion from David's review. (1 mark)

3 **Question 8:** Explain how David uses adjectives to describe the staff and facilities. (2 marks)

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

# Mock 1 • Text B Questions & Text C Introduction

## Reading Passage

Text C • Staff Operational Memo:
From: Clinic Operations Manager
To: All Nursing & Administrative Staff
Date: 12 October 2026
Subject: Annual Flu Vaccination Clinic Logistics

All staff must complete their mandatory infection control refresher training by Friday 24 October. Flu vaccination clinics commence Monday 3 November in Seminar Room B.

1 **Question 9:** In David's review in Text B, what does the word 'reassuring' suggest about Sister Sarah? (1 mark)

2 **Question 10:** Identify the date by which staff must complete their refresher training. (1 mark)

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

# Mock 1 • Text C: Operational Memo Details

## Reading Passage

To maintain efficient patient flow, please adhere strictly to the 10-minute appointment slots. Laminated patient pathway flowcharts are displayed in the staff breakroom. Any adverse vaccine reactions must be logged in the yellow clinical incident binder within 30 minutes of occurrence.

1 **Question 11:** Where can staff find the laminated patient pathway flowcharts? (1 mark)

2 **Question 12:** Where must adverse vaccine reactions be recorded? (1 mark)

3 **Question 13:** Within what timeframe must an adverse reaction be logged? (1 mark)

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

# Mock 1 • Text C Layout & Comparison Questions

## Reading Passage

The memo uses bold subheadings and bullet points so that operational instructions are clear during busy clinic hours. All staff receive a complimentary hot beverage voucher from the cafeteria.

1 **Question 14:** Identify two layout features used in Text C and explain how they help the reader. (2 marks)

2 **Question 15:** Both Text A and Text C discuss healthcare clinics. Compare one difference in audience between Text A and Text C. (2 marks)

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

# Mock 1 • Mock 1 • Candidate Self-Audit Matrix

## Reading Passage

Complete your review of Paper 1 before marking your score against the official solutions on p81.

1 **Question 16:** Summarize two key pieces of advice you would give to someone visiting the Greendale Centre for the first time. (2 marks)

MOCK 2

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 1 • 60 MINUTES • 30 MARKS

# Official Reading Mock Examination • Paper 2

## Examination Protocol

**Instructions for Candidates:**

- This paper contains 3 reading texts on workplace apprenticeship training and health and safety.
- Answer all questions in the spaces provided.
- Time allowed: 60 minutes. Total marks: 30 marks.
- Check your answers against the official mark scheme on p86.

## Top Scoring Tip

Keep your answers precise and directly quote the passage where appropriate.

## Question Phrasing

Watch out for words like 'except' or 'not' in multiple-choice questions.

## ✎ Personal Target Score & Time Checkpoints

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

# Mock 2 • Text A: Oxfordshire Council Apprenticeship Guide

## Reading Passage

The Oxfordshire Council Apprenticeship Programme offers paid apprenticeships across digital skills, business administration, and horticulture. Apprentices receive a starting salary of £19,500 per annum, 25 days of paid annual leave, and fully funded qualifications up to Level 3. Applicants must be aged 16 or over and hold GCSEs in English and Maths at Grade 3 or Functional Skills Level 1.

1 **Question 1:** According to Text A, what is the starting salary for an apprentice? (1 mark)

2 **Question 2:** State two qualification fields offered on the apprenticeship programme. (2 marks)

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

# Mock 2 • Text A Continued & Questions

## Reading Passage

All applications must be submitted via the online portal by Friday 28 November 2026. Successful candidates will be invited for assessment days during the second week of December. If you need reasonable adjustments for the interview, contact the disability support coordinator at hr@oxfordshire.gov.uk.

1 **Question 3:** What is the final deadline date for submitting an application? (1 mark)

2 **Question 4:** Who should applicants contact if they require reasonable adjustments? (1 mark)

3 **Question 5:** What text type is Text A? (1 mark)

- [ ] An informal personal diary
- [ ] An informative official recruitment guide
- [ ] A critical newspaper review
- [ ] A recipe instruction card

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

M2

# Mock 2 • Text B: Apprentice Case Study • Marcus

## Reading Passage

Marcus Davies, Digital Support Apprentice:
*'Joining the council digital team was the best decision of my career! I was nervous on my first day, but my mentor Abdul guided me through every software deployment. The workplace culture is wonderfully welcoming and positive. Last month, I configured 85 new laptops for field healthcare workers.'*

1 **Question 6:** Extract one fact from Marcus's case study. (1 mark)

2 **Question 7:** Extract one opinion from Marcus's case study. (1 mark)

3 **Question 8:** How does Marcus describe the workplace culture? (1 mark)

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

# Mock 2 • Text B Questions & Text C Introduction

## Reading Passage

Text C • Depot Health & Safety Policy Notice:
All warehouse and IT depot employees must wear high-visibility vests and steel toe-capped safety boots at all times in the logistics bay. Forklift operating lanes are marked with yellow cross-hatch lines. Pedestrians must strictly use the green painted walkways.

1 **Question 9:** In Marcus's account, how did mentor Abdul support him? (1 mark)

2 **Question 10:** According to Text C, what two items of PPE are compulsory in the logistics bay? (2 marks)

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

# Mock 2 • Text C: Depot Safety Rules

## Reading Passage

Mobile phones are strictly prohibited while walking through the loading bays. Earphones must never be worn as they prevent staff from hearing forklift reverse warning alarms. In the event of a spillage, immediately erect the yellow 'Caution: Wet Floor' warning cones.

1 **Question 11:** Why are earphones prohibited in the loading bays? (1 mark)

2 **Question 12:** What action must an employee take immediately if a liquid spillage occurs? (1 mark)

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

# Mock 2 • Text C Layout & Comparison Questions

## Reading Passage

Text C uses bold uppercase lettering and warning symbols to emphasize urgent safety protocols. Failure to observe safety notices may result in formal disciplinary action under section 4 of the Employment Contract.

1 **Question 13:** Explain why the writer of Text C used bold uppercase lettering for key safety rules. (1 mark)

2 **Question 14:** Both Text A and Text C are written for council employees. Identify one difference in purpose between Text A and Text C. (2 marks)

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

# Mock 2 • Mock 2 • Candidate Self-Audit Matrix

## Reading Passage

Check your answers against the official mark scheme before recording your final score.

1 **Question 15:** What advice does Text C give regarding mobile phone usage? (1 mark)

2 **Question 16:** Summarize two benefits of doing an apprenticeship as described across Text A and Text B. (2 marks)

MS1

RETRIEVAL & IDENTIFICATION MARK SCHEMES (L1.9–L1.11)

# Official Mark Scheme • Part 1 of 6

## Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

**Examiner Assessment Guidance:**

Pearson Edexcel Level 1 Reading awards marks for accurate factual extraction. Accept direct quotes or unambiguous paraphrasing that answers the question precisely.

**Standard Marking Rules:**

- Do not penalize spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

## ✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 1)

MS2

LAYOUT & ORGANIZATIONAL DEVICES MARK SCHEME (L1.12)

# Official Mark Scheme • Part 2 of 6

## Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

**Examiner Assessment Guidance:**

To achieve full marks on layout questions, candidates must identify the specific device (e.g. bullet points, headings, columns) AND explain its functional benefit for the reader.

**Standard Marking Rules:**

- Do not penalize spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

## ✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 2)

MS3

FACT VS. OPINION ASSESSMENT CRITERIA (L1.9)

# Official Mark Scheme • Part 3 of 6

## Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

**Examiner Assessment Guidance:**

Award 1 mark for verifiable factual statement supported by records or metrics.
Award 1 mark for subjective opinion containing evaluative vocabulary.

**Standard Marking Rules:**

- Do not penalize spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

## ✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 3)

MS4

VOCABULARY IN CONTEXT MARK SCHEME (L1.10–L1.11)

# Official Mark Scheme • Part 4 of 6

## Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

**Examiner Assessment Guidance:**
Candidates must demonstrate understanding of words in their specific sentence context rather than offering unrelated dictionary definitions.

**Standard Marking Rules:**

- Do not penalize spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

## ✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 4)

MS5

TEXT PURPOSE & AUDIENCE ASSESSMENT GRIDS (L1.16–L1.17)

# Official Mark Scheme • Part 5 of 6

## Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

**Examiner Assessment Guidance:**

Candidates must accurately link purpose verbs (persuade, inform, explain, instruct) to evidence in the text.

**Standard Marking Rules:**

- Do not penalize spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

## ✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 5)

MS6

COMPARISON OF TWO TEXTS MARK SCHEME (L1.17)

# Official Mark Scheme • Part 6 of 6

## Mark Scheme Standards & Criteria

**Examiner Assessment Guidance:**

Award marks for direct comparative links between Text A and Text B identifying similarities or differences in ideas, audience, or purpose.

**Standard Marking Rules:**

- Do not penalize spelling, punctuation, or grammar errors in the Reading paper provided meaning is clear.
- Where a question asks for TWO points, do not award marks for two variations of the same idea.
- Answers copied verbatim from the text are acceptable if they answer the specific question asked.

## ✎ Personal Marking Notes & Checkpoints (Part 6)

# REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX

Complete Worked Solutions, Lexicon & Alphabetical Index

## TOPIC 1: FACT OR OPINION SOLUTIONS

**R1** **Steps:** Fact: 'The electric delivery vans cut depot fuel expenditure by £14,500.' (verifiable in accounting records)
Opinion: 'They are undeniably the most stylish commercial vehicles on British roads today.' (subjective aesthetic judgment).
**Answer:** Fact: Reduced fuel expenditure by £14,500 | Opinion: Most stylish commercial vehicles on British roads today. **[2 Marks]**

## TOPIC 2: WORDS IN CONTEXT & MEANING SOLUTIONS

**R2** **Steps:** Isolate: Disconnect, cut off, or safely separate from power supply.
Imminent: About to happen immediately, forthcoming, or looming.
**Answer:** Isolate = Disconnect from power. Imminent = About to occur immediately. **[2 Marks]**

## TOPIC 3: SPECIALIST & TECHNICAL VOCABULARY SOLUTIONS

**R3** **Steps:** (a) Contraindicated: Not recommended, inadvisable, or dangerous to administer.
(b) Renal impairment: Kidney damage, kidney disease, or reduced kidney function.
**Answer:** (a) Not suitable/unsafe for use. (b) Kidney damage or dysfunction. **[2 Marks]**

## TOPIC 4: PRESENTATIONAL FEATURES SOLUTIONS

**R4** **Steps:** Feature: Shaded/coloured text box (callout box / alert banner).
Purpose: Draws immediate visual attention to critical arrival instructions before the patient reads anything else.
**Answer:** Feature: Shaded callout banner. Purpose: Highlights time-sensitive arrival requirements immediately. **[2 Marks]**

## TOPIC 5: LAYOUT DEVICES & VISUAL SIGNPOSTING SOLUTIONS

**R5** **Steps:** Advantage 1: Aligns cut-off dates alongside payment dates in clear corresponding rows.
Advantage 2: Makes it fast and easy for payroll clerks to look up specific months without missing vital deadlines.
**Answer:** 1. Aligns matching data horizontally. 2. Provides quick scanning for specific monthly deadlines. **[2 Marks]**

## TOPIC 6: IMAGES, GRAPHICS & CAPTIONS SOLUTIONS

**R6** **Steps:** Reason: The photo creates emotional distress by showing innocent wildlife directly harmed by plastic, making the crisis personal and urgent rather than an abstract numerical statistic.
**Answer:** Generates emotional distress/empathy and provides direct visual proof of harm to marine wildlife. **[2 Marks]**

## TOPIC 7: LANGUAGE DEVICES & RHETORICAL TECHNIQUES SOLUTIONS

**R7** **Steps:** Technique: Hyperbole / Emotive language / Contrast.
Effect: Elevates staffing levels from a routine budget issue into an urgent moral crisis.
**Answer:** Technique: Emotive language / Contrast. Effect: Emphasizes critical danger and urgency to compel action. **[2 Marks]**

## TOPIC 8: POINT OF VIEW, BIAS & ARGUMENTATION SOLUTIONS

**R8** **Steps:** Stance: Strongly opposed to the new roster schedule.
Bias Reason: Uses loaded emotional language ('unmitigated disaster', 'exploit') without presenting any of management's operational rationale.
**Answer:** Opposes roster changes; demonstrates bias through extreme, loaded adjectives without presenting management's justification. **[2 Marks]**

## TOPIC 9: TONE, STYLE & WRITER'S VOICE SOLUTIONS

**R9** **Steps:** Tone: Informal, friendly, conversational.
Quote: 'We get it' or 'feels like a chore'.
**Answer:** Tone: Conversational / informal. Quote: 'We get it'. **[2 Marks]**

## TOPIC 10: TEXT TYPES, PURPOSE & AUDIENCE SOLUTIONS

**R10** **Steps:** Text type: Workplace safety instruction manual / SOP.
Primary purpose: To instruct healthcare staff on the safe protocol for disposing of sharp clinical items.
**Answer:** Text type: Safety guidance document / SOP.
Primary purpose: To instruct staff on safe clinical disposal. **[2 Marks]**

## TOPIC 11: COMPARING TEXTS & CONTRASTING PERSPECTIVES SOLUTIONS

**R11** **Steps:** Both texts discuss remote medical appointments.
Text A champions them as empowering and convenient ('eliminating travel'), whereas Text B highlights digital exclusion and barriers for elderly individuals ('alienate elderly patients').
**Answer:** Text A views virtual appointments as empowering and time-saving, whereas Text B criticizes them for excluding vulnerable elderly patients without digital skills. **[3 Marks]**

# REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

## TOPIC 12: AUTHORIAL INTENT & TARGET AUDIENCE SOLUTIONS

**R12** **Steps:** Motivation: To campaign and advocate for increased statutory and charitable funding for palliative care services by emphasizing patient dignity.
**Answer:** To advocate for equal government and charitable funding for hospice and palliative care. **[2 Marks]**

## OFFICIAL READING MOCK EXAMINATION 1 • FULL MARK SCHEME & SOLUTIONS (30 MARKS)

**Q1** 19:30 (7:30 pm) **[1m]**
*Direct retrieval from Text A paragraph 1.*

**Q2** Health checks / Smoking cessation clinics / Diabetes prevention workshops (any two) **[2m]**
*1 mark for each service listed.*

**Q3** 48 hours in advance **[1m]**
*Direct retrieval.*

**Q4** Costs the centre over £12,000 / denies another patient a time slot **[1m]**
*Accept either consequence.*

**Q5** B: To inform the public about services and opening hours **[1m]**
*Multiple choice correct key.*

**Q6** Visited yesterday / Nurse was Sister Sarah / Had blood pressure check **[1m]**
*Verifiable fact.*

**Q7** Sister Sarah was exceptionally kind / Finest healthcare facility in Oxfordshire **[1m]**
*Subjective opinion.*

**Q8** Kind, reassuring, clean, spacious — creates an encouraging and positive impression **[2m]**
*1 mark for quote, 1 mark for effect.*

**Q9** She made the patient feel calm, relaxed, and safe during the test **[1m]**
*Vocabulary inference.*

**Q10** Friday 24 October **[1m]**
*Direct retrieval.*

**Q11** In the staff breakroom **[1m]**
*Direct retrieval.*

**Q12** Yellow clinical incident binder **[1m]**
*Direct retrieval.*

**Q13** Within 30 minutes of occurrence **[1m]**
*Direct retrieval.*

**Q14** Bold headings organize topics; bullet points present rules clearly for quick reading **[2m]**
*1m for features, 1m for effect.*

**Q15** Text A is for general public/patients; Text C is for internal clinical/administrative staff **[2m]**
*1m for Text A audience, 1m for Text C.*

**Q16** Book appointments in advance; utilize free 2-hour parking in morning clinics **[2m]**
*1m for each valid recommendation.*

# REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

## OFFICIAL READING MOCK EXAMINATION 2 • FULL MARK SCHEME & SOLUTIONS (30 MARKS)

**Q1** £19,500 per annum **[1m]**
*Direct retrieval from Text A.*

**Q2** Digital skills / Business administration / Horticulture (any two) **[2m]**
*1m each.*

**Q3** Friday 28 November 2026 **[1m]**
*Direct retrieval.*

**Q4** Disability support coordinator (hr@oxfordshire.gov.uk) **[1m]**
*Direct retrieval.*

**Q5** B: An informative official recruitment guide **[1m]**
*Multiple choice key.*

**Q6** Configured 85 new laptops / Mentor was Abdul **[1m]**
*Verifiable fact.*

**Q7** Best decision of my career / Wonderfully welcoming workplace culture **[1m]**
*Subjective opinion.*

**Q8** Wonderfully welcoming and positive **[1m]**
*Direct quote.*

**Q9** Abdul guided him through software deployments and helped him overcome nervousness **[1m]**
*Explanation.*

**Q10** High-visibility vests AND steel toe-capped safety boots **[2m]**
*1m for each PPE item.*

**Q11** They prevent workers from hearing forklift reverse warning alarms **[1m]**
*Safety justification.*

**Q12** Erect yellow 'Caution: Wet Floor' warning cones immediately **[1m]**
*Action required.*

**Q13** To emphasize urgent mandatory health and safety rules so they are immediately noticed **[1m]**
*Layout effect.*

**Q14** Text A aims to recruit and inform applicants; Text C aims to enforce strict safety rules **[2m]**
*Purpose comparison.*

**Q15** Mobile phones are strictly prohibited while walking through loading bays **[1m]**
*Rule retrieval.*

**Q16** Earn a salary while training (£19,500); receive mentorship and gain qualifications **[2m]**
*Synthesis across texts.*

## ESSENTIAL GLOSSARY OF READING & COMPREHENSION TERMINOLOGY

**Audience:** The specific group of readers a text is written for (e.g. staff, patients, general public).

**Bias:** A one-sided viewpoint that favors one perspective over another, often lacking balance.

**Caption:** A brief text explanation placed beneath an image or diagram.

**Context:** The surrounding words, sentences, or background situation that gives a word or text its meaning.

**Fact:** A verifiable piece of information that can be proven true by records, measurements, or evidence.

**Headline / Heading:** The main title of an article or document designed to state the subject clearly.

**Implicit Meaning:** Information that is suggested or hinted at rather than directly stated.

**Informative Text:** A text whose main purpose is to give clear, factual information to the reader.

**Layout Feature:** A visual or structural element (columns, bullet points, boxes) that organizes content.

**Opinion:** A personal belief, attitude, or feeling that cannot be verified as an objective fact.

**Persuasive Text:** A text designed to convince the reader to take action or agree with a specific viewpoint.

**Purpose:** The main reason why the author wrote the text (to inform, instruct, explain, or persuade).

**Retrieval:** Finding and extracting specific facts, figures, or dates directly from a text.

**Subheading:** A smaller heading that divides an article or document into clear sections.

**Tone:** The mood, feeling, or attitude conveyed by the writer's choice of words.

# REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

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